

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250285403

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 11, 2025

Inventor(s)

Shayne; Ethan et al.

CAMERA BLINDSPOT ANALYSIS

Abstract

Methods, systems, and apparatus, including computer programs encoded on computer storage media, for detecting packages delivering in the camera's blindspot. One of the methods includes detecting, using one or more images captured by a camera at a property, movement in an area of interest i) at the property, ii) that is included in a field of view of the camera and iii) was generated using historical data for packages delivered to the property; determining, using the detected movement in the area of interest, that a package was likely delivered; and in response to determining that the package was likely delivered, performing one or more automated actions for the package.

Inventors: Shayne; Ethan (Herndon, VA), Madden; Donald Gerard (Columbia, MD), Beach; Allison (Leesburg, VA), Ramanathan; Narayanan (Chantilly, VA), Kerzner; Daniel Todd (McLean, VA)

Applicant: ALARM.COM INCORPORATED (Tysons, VA)

Family ID: 85797480

Appl. No.: 19/217115

Filed: May 23, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

parent US continuation 17962108 20221007 parent-grant-document US 12315210 child US 19217115

us-provisional-application US 63254736 20211012

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G06V10/25 (20220101); G06T7/246 (20170101); G06V20/40 (20220101); G08B13/196 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G06V10/25** (20220101); **G06T7/248** (20170101); **G08B13/19613** (20130101);
G06V20/41 (20220101)

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/962,108, filed Oct. 7, 2022, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/254,736, filed Oct. 12, 2021, the contents of which are incorporated by reference herein.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] This disclosure application relates generally to camera object detection.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Many properties are equipped with monitoring systems that include sensors and connected system components. Monitoring systems can receive and analyze data from sensors that are internal and external to the property. Some monitoring systems include cameras. Delivery services can deliver packages to a property. In some cases, packages may be delivered to locations of a property that are not within a field of view of a camera installed at the property.

SUMMARY

[0004] Techniques are described for monitoring packages delivered to camera blindspots. Video can be captured by a camera installed at a property. For example, the camera may be a doorbell camera that is installed at a door of a property and that can capture images of a package delivered to the property. The disclosed techniques can be used to build a model of the package delivery scene, including identifying blindspots of installed cameras at the property. The model of the delivery scene can then be used to detect deliveries to blindspots and to monitor packages that have been delivered to blindspots in order to guard against damage and theft.

[0005] In many residential installations, a camera may be built into a doorbell or mounted near a door. Installed cameras may have a limited and/or fixed field of view and therefore might not be able to capture images of a package after the package has been delivered. Additionally, the appearance and structure of the package might not be clear from the view of an installed camera. Thus, an installed camera likely has blindspots. This has particular implications for package delivery detection, where a package may be delivered or removed without being detected by the camera.

[0006] The disclosed techniques can be used to monitor and guard packages that have been delivered to blindspots. For example, when a blindspot delivery is detected, the camera may be adjusted in order to monitor the package. In some examples, additional cameras can be deployed to monitor the package. In some examples, the camera can estimate a location of the package and can generate an area of interest around the estimated location. When a person approaches or enters the area of interest, the camera can perform an action such as sending a notification to a resident of the property or activating a warning signal to warn the person not to approach the package.

[0007] Other implementations of this aspect include corresponding systems, apparatus, and computer programs recorded on computer storage devices, each configured to perform the operations of the methods.

[0008] In general, one innovative aspect of the subject matter described in this specification can be embodied in methods that include the actions of detecting, using one or more images captured by a camera at a property, movement in an area of interest i) at the property, ii) that is included in a field of view of the camera and iii) was generated using historical data for packages delivered to the

property; determining, using the detected movement in the area of interest, that a package was likely delivered; and in response to determining that the package was likely delivered, performing one or more automated actions for the package.

[0009] Other embodiments of this aspect include corresponding computer systems, apparatus, computer program products, and computer programs recorded on one or more computer storage devices, each configured to perform the actions of the methods. A system of one or more computers can be configured to perform particular operations or actions by virtue of having software, firmware, hardware, or a combination of them installed on the system that in operation causes or cause the system to perform the actions. One or more computer programs can be configured to perform particular operations or actions by virtue of including instructions that, when executed by data processing apparatus, cause the apparatus to perform the actions.

[0010] The foregoing and other embodiments can each optionally include one or more of the following features, alone or in combination.

[0011] In some implementations, the method includes determining that a first package was delivered to a location not depicted in the one or more images captured by the camera at the property; and in response to determining that the first package was likely delivered to the location not depicted in the one or more images captured by the camera at the property, generating the area of interest in the field of view of the camera.

[0012] In some implementations, the method includes determining that the package was likely delivered to the location not depicted in the one or more images captured by the camera at the property uses one or more first images captured by the camera.

[0013] In some implementations, the location not depicted in the one or more images captured by the camera comprises a location outside the field of view of the camera or an occluded location behind one or more objects depicted in at least the one or more images captured by the camera.

[0014] In some implementations, the method includes, performing the one or more automated actions for the package comprises, in response to determining that the package was likely delivered, providing, to a device for an occupant of the property, instructions to cause the device to present a notification about the package.

[0015] In some implementations, the method includes performing the one or more automated actions for the package comprises, in response to determining that the package was likely delivered, sending, to the camera, instructions to cause the camera to capture, using a second field of view, one or more second images that depict a location at which the package was likely delivered.

[0016] In some implementations, the method includes performing the one or more automated actions for the package comprises: detecting, using one or more second images captured by the camera, second movement in the area of interest; and in response to determining that the package was likely delivered and detecting the second movement in the area of interest, causing presentation of a warning.

[0017] In some implementations, the method includes detecting the movement in the area of interest comprises detecting, using one or more first images captured by the camera that depict the package, the movement in the area of interest; and determining, using the detected movement in the area of interest, that the package was likely delivered comprises determining, using the one or more first images from which the movement in the area of interest was detected and one or more second images a) captured by the camera after the one or more first images b) that do not depict the package, that the package was likely delivered.

[0018] In some implementations, the method includes detecting the movement in the area of interest comprises detecting, using the one or more images captured by the camera, the movement of a person or a robot in the area of interest.

[0019] In some implementations, the method includes detecting the movement in the area of interest comprises detecting, using the one or more images captured by the camera, the movement

in the area of interest around an area at which the historical data indicates one or more packages were previously delivered.

[0020] The details of one or more implementations of the subject matter described in this specification are set forth in the accompanying drawings and the description below. Other features, aspects, and advantages of the subject matter will become apparent from the description and the drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0021] FIG. 1 illustrates an example system for monitoring packages delivered to camera blindspots.

[0022] FIG. 2 is a flow diagram of an example process for monitoring packages delivered to camera blindspots.

[0023] FIG. 3 is a diagram illustrating an example of a monitoring system.

[0024] Like reference numbers and designations in the various drawings indicate like elements.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0025] FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating an example environment **100** for monitoring packages delivered to camera blindspots. The environment **100** includes a camera **104** installed at a property **102**. The property **102** can be a home, another residence, a place of business, a public space, or another facility that is monitored by a monitoring system that implements one or more components from the environment **100**.

[0026] A camera **104** is installed at the property **102**. The camera **104** can be, for example, a surveillance camera installed at the property **102**. The camera **104** is installed external to the property **102**. The camera **104** is installed near a door **103**, facing a yard of the property **102**. However, the camera **104** may instead be installed internal to the property **102**. For example, the camera **104** may be inside the property **102** next to a window facing outwards with a clear view of a yard of the property **102**.

[0027] The camera **104** can be a component of a monitoring system, e.g., a doorbell camera, or another appropriate type of system. In some examples, the camera **104** can be configured to record continuously. In some examples, the camera **104** can be configured to record at designated times, such as on demand, when triggered by another sensor of the environment **100**, or when triggered by detection of object motion within a field of view of the camera **104**.

[0028] The camera **104** can capture visual images of scenes at the property within the field of view. The camera **104** may perform video analysis on captured images. Video analysis can include, for example, event detection, object detection, and object classification. In some examples, the camera **104** can send image data to a computing system, e.g., a monitoring server, and the monitoring server can perform video analysis on the captured images. In some examples, the camera **104** and the monitoring server can each perform video analysis on the captured images. For example, the camera **104** can perform object detection, while the monitoring server can perform object classification.

[0029] To support communications with computing devices such as a monitoring server or a mobile device **115**, the camera **104** can include a communications module, such as a modem, transceiver, modulator, or other hardware or software configured to enable the camera **104** to communicate electronic data to the monitoring server. The camera **104** can send data over a long-range data link. The long-range data link can include any combination of wired and wireless data networks. For example, the monitoring server can exchange information with the camera **104** through a wide-area-network (WAN), a broadband internet connection, a cellular telephony network, a wireless data network, a cable connection, a digital subscriber line (DSL), a satellite connection, or other

electronic means for data transmission. In some implementations, the long-range data link between a monitoring server and the camera **104** is a secure data link (e.g., a virtual private network) such that the data exchanged between the monitoring server and the camera **104** is encoded to protect against interception by an adverse third party.

[0030] FIG. **1** illustrates a package **110** that has been delivered to the property **102** by a delivery person **114**. The porch **111** is within the field of view of the camera **104**. A resident **116** of the property may be located at the property **102** or at a location away from the property **102**. The delivery person **114** delivers the package **110** to a location **118** at the property **102** that is outside of the field of view of the camera **104**.

[0031] The example illustrated in FIG. **1** includes one camera **104** and one package **110**. However, some examples can include additional cameras and/or packages. The package **110** can be, for example, a package ordered by the resident **116** from a delivery service, such as a bag of food or a box of consumer products. In some examples, the package **110** can be a package sent to the resident **116** by another person, such as a box of gifts sent to the resident **116** through a mail service.

[0032] The delivery person **114** may be an employee or contractor of a delivery service organization. The delivery service organization can be, for example, an internet sales company, a shipping company, or a postal service. The delivery person **114** is a person assigned to deliver the package **110** to the property **102**.

[0033] The resident **116** is associated with the mobile device **115**. The mobile device **115** can be, for example, a smart phone or tablet computer. The mobile device **115** includes a communication module for communicating over one or more wireless networks. For example, the mobile device **115** can each connect to the internet using a cellular or Wi-Fi network. The mobile device **115** can each communicate wirelessly with, for example, a GPS satellite system, the monitoring server, the camera **104**, and other computing devices. The mobile device **115** can receive and send text messages, emails, and telephone calls, and can communicate with the camera **104** through a mobile application.

[0034] In some examples, in addition to or instead of a delivery person **114**, the package **110** can be delivered by a robot. For example, the package **110** can be delivered by an aerial robot or a ground transportation robot. The robot may be owned and/or operated by a delivery service and can navigate to the property **102** based on automated control technology and/or user input control provided by a user.

[0035] The camera **104** captures a first set of images **126**. The first set of images **126** shows the porch **111** from the perspective of the camera **104**. The first set of images **126** can include images captured by the camera **104** and generated from any appropriate type of light. For example, the images can be generated from any combination of visible light, IR light, or UV light. The images can also be generated from RADAR, LIDAR, and/or microwave imaging. The first set of images **126** can include any combination of still images, recorded video, or live-streamed video.

[0036] The first set of images **126** includes image **124**. The image **124** includes a depiction of the porch **111** and a shrub **122**. The image **124** also includes a depiction of the delivery person **114** carrying the package **110**.

[0037] The camera **104** can perform video analysis including, e.g., human detection, recognition, and tracking, object detection, recognition, and tracking, background change detection, event detection, etc. In the example of FIG. **1**, the camera **104** determines, based on analyzing the first set of images **126**, that the delivery person **114** carries the package **110** along the path **113**. The path **113** leads outside of the field of view of the camera **104**. In some examples, the camera **104** may determine that the first set of images **126** depicts the delivery person **114** approaching the property **102** with the package **110** and departing from the property **102** without the package **110**.

[0038] In some examples, the camera **104** can perform an action to assist the delivery person in delivering the package **110** to a location that is not a blindspot of the camera **104**. For example, the camera **104** may predict that the delivery person **114** is going to deliver the package **110** to a

blindspot based on determining that the delivery person **114** departs from the walkway **125** along the path **113**. Based on predicting that the delivery person **114** is going to deliver the package **110** to a blindspot, the camera **104** can activate one or more signals to guide the delivery person **114** to a location within the field of view of the camera **104**.

[0039] As an example, a light may be located near the porch **111**. The camera **104** can transmit a command to the light that causes the light to illuminate a location where the package **110** should be delivered. In another example, an audio speaker may be located near the porch **111**. The camera **104** can transmit a command to the audio speaker that causes the audio speaker to broadcast sound such as a voice that instructs the person **140** where to deliver the package **110**. In some examples, the package **110** may be delivered by a robot, and the camera **104** can transmit wireless commands to the robot indicating a location where the package **110** should be delivered.

[0040] In some examples, the camera **104** can analyze the first set of images **126** to determine a time of a delivery event. For example, the camera **104** can identify images included in the first set of images **126** that depict likely delivery events, e.g., images of the delivery person **114** approaching the property **102** with the package **110**. Based on timestamps of the first set of images **126** that show a likely delivery event, the camera **104** can determine a time when the package **110** was delivered to the property **102**.

[0041] The camera **104** includes a scene model database **142**, a blindspot delivery detector **146**, an area of interest (AOI) generator **150**, and a blindspot monitor **154**. The scene model database **142** stores a spatial model of one or more scenes where packages may be delivered at the property **102**. For example, the scene model database **142** can store a model of a scene or scenes including the porch **111**. In some examples, the scene model database **142** can build the scene model **144** using images captured by multiple installed cameras with overlapping field of view, e.g., the camera **104** and any other cameras at the property that have a field of view that includes the porch **111**. Geometric relationships between the multiple cameras can be stored by the monitoring server. The geometric relationships can be determined using image analysis, based on programmed installation positions of the cameras, or both. In some examples, the scene model database **142** can store spatial models of scenes at multiple properties.

[0042] In some examples, the scene model **144** can be developed during a training or setup phase of the system. For example, a user can perform a survey by using a camera, e.g., a camera that is part of a mobile device, to capture video or still images of scenes at the property **102** where packages are likely to be delivered. The user can provide the captured images to the server **120**. The server can store the captured images in the scene model database **142** and can use the captured images to build the scene model **144**.

[0043] In some examples, the scene model database **142** can generate, build, or improve the scene model **144** over time. The scene model database **142** can build the model of the scene using images captured by the camera **104** and by any other cameras installed at the property **102**.

[0044] In some examples, the scene model database **142** can be augmented using delivery images. Delivery images can be images of a package that are captured by a delivery person after delivering the package to a property. For example, after placing the package **110** next to the porch **111**, the delivery person **114** may use a mobile device to capture an image of the package **110**. The delivery person **114** uploads the image, using a mobile application, to a computing system that provides the image to the resident, e.g., through an email, text message, or push notification. The delivery images can be forwarded to the camera **104** or can be intercepted by the camera **104** for use in updating the scene model database **142**.

[0045] Delivery images can augment the scene model database **142** and improve accuracy of the 3D model of the area around the porch **111**. Since the delivery images are likely not captured from the same perspective view as the camera **104**, the delivery image can provide an alternate view of the area around the porch **111**. In some examples, the delivery can provide a view that may include blindspots of the camera **104**. By combining data from the delivery images with data from images

captured by the camera **104**, the blindspots can be identified in the scene model **144**.

[0046] The scene model database **142** can store data indicating an estimation of the relative orientation of the ground plane including pixels of images captured by the camera **104** that correspond to the ground. The camera **104** can learn which pixels correspond to the ground, e.g., using machine learning methods. The monitoring server can analyze images captured by the camera **104** showing people, animals, and vehicles traversing over the ground. Based on analyzing the images, the monitoring server can identify the ground plane. Identifying the ground plane can enable the monitoring server to estimate the planar geometry of the scene. For example, the monitoring server can assume that the porch **111** is part of the ground plane of the scene and has a planar shape.

[0047] The scene model database **142** can store data indicating estimated locations of occlusions within the field of view of the camera **104**. An occlusion can be an area that an object blocks the camera **104** from view. For example, an area behind the porch **111** and an area behind the shrub **122** can both be occlusion areas. In some examples, the camera **104** can identify occlusions based on analyzing camera images over time. For example, the camera **104** can analyze images of a person stepping on to and/or off of the porch **111** in order to identify occlusion areas in the field of view. In an example, the camera **104** can determine that a first foot of a person is not visible to the camera when the person steps on to the porch **111** with a second foot. Thus, the camera **104** can determine that an occlusion area exists behind the edge of the porch **111**. The scene model database **142** can store data labeling the identified occlusion areas as blindspots. In another example, the camera **104** can analyze images of people crossing behind an obstruction such as the shrub. The camera **104** can determine that there is an occlusion area behind the shrub **122**, and can label the occlusion area as a blindspot in the scene model **144**.

[0048] In some implementations, upon installation, the system may have a training phase. The training phase can be used to generate scene model data for storage in the scene model database **142**, historical delivery data for storage in the historical delivery database **162**, or both.

[0049] In some examples, the training phase may be a period of multiple days or weeks. During the training phase, the camera can obtain images of all package deliveries to the property **102**. The camera can store paths taken by delivery personnel. The camera can also store locations of packages that are delivered during the training phase. In some examples, in addition to or instead of the training phase, the camera **104** can continuously store record and store delivery paths and delivery locations while in operation. The camera can analyze all deliveries, or a selection of deliveries. In some examples, the camera **104** can continue to update the scene model database and/or the historical delivery database **162** after completion of the training phase. Thus, accuracy of the camera **104** can continuously improve over time while in operation.

[0050] The blindspot delivery detector **146** compares the first set of images **126** to the scene model **144** to determine if the package **110** was delivered to a blindspot of the camera **104**. In some examples, the blindspot delivery detector **146** can select a version of the scene model **144** based on environmental conditions at the property **102**. For example, the scene model database **142** can store scene models that represent the scene at various times of day, seasons of year, precipitation conditions, etc. The blindspot delivery detector **146** can select a particular version of the scene model **144** that most closely matches the current date, time, and/or weather conditions. In some examples, the scene model database **142** can store scene models for multiple properties, and the blindspot delivery detector **146** can select the scene model **144** for the particular property **102**.

[0051] The scene model **144** can include landmarks within view of the camera **104**. The landmarks can have a set of precomputed feature descriptors and/or precomputed three-dimensional poses within the scene. In some cases, the feature descriptors and poses can be learned over time using machine learning processes. In some cases, the features descriptors and poses can be measured or computed during a setup and training phase of the system. The blindspot delivery detector **146** can use the landmarks to match the first set of images **126** to the scene model **144**. Example landmarks

can include, for example, edges and corners of the porch **111**, edges and corners of the door **103**, etc.

[0052] In some examples, the camera **104** might not be able to determine, based on image analysis, whether or not a person in an image is carrying a package. For example, the delivery person **114** may be facing the camera **104** when approaching the property **102**, but may have his or her back to the camera **104** when departing from the property **102**. In some examples, the package **110** may be too small for the camera **104** to detect in the first set of images **126**. The camera **104** can be operable to perform blindspot delivery detection whether or not the package **110** is ever visible to the camera **104**. In some examples, the camera **104** can perform blindspot delivery detection based on image analysis of images of the delivery person **114** and/or a vehicle operated by the delivery person **114**. In some examples, the camera **104** can perform blindspot delivery detection based on delivery schedule data **165** and/or historical delivery database **162**.

[0053] The blindspot delivery detector **146** can determine that a blindspot delivery has occurred based on analysis of images of the delivery person **114** and/or images of a vehicle operated by the delivery person **114**. The camera **104** can be trained to perform image analysis to identify vehicles, uniforms, and logos associated with delivery services. For example, the camera **104** can be trained to identify vehicles, uniforms, and/or logos associated with a postal service such as the United States Postal Service (USPS). The camera **104** can be trained, e.g., using machine learning methods.

[0054] The camera **104** can determine that the first set of images **126** depicts a USPS truck, and a person approaching the property **102** wearing a USPS uniform. Thus, the camera **104** can determine a high likelihood that a delivery is in progress. The camera **104** can track the person as the person approaches the property **102** and departs from the property **102**. Based on the tracked movement of the person, the camera **104** can determine a likely location where the person delivered the package.

[0055] The blindspot delivery detector **146** can determine that a blindspot delivery has occurred based on external data such as delivery schedule data **165**. For example, the camera **104** can receive data indicating a delivery schedule for the property **102**. The delivery schedule data **165** can include schedule data for one or more expected deliveries at the property. For example, the delivery schedule data **165** can include data indicating that a first delivery from the USPS is expected between 10 am and 12 pm and that a second delivery from FedEx is expected between 1 pm and 3 pm. The first set of images **126** is captured around 10:30 am. The blindspot delivery detector **146** can therefore determine, based on the delivery schedule data **165** and the timestamps of the first set of images **126**, that the delivery person **114** approaching the property **102** is likely executing the first delivery from the USPS. The blindspot delivery detector **146** can then determine that a blindspot delivery has occurred based on tracking movement of the delivery person **114** along the path **113**.

[0056] In some examples, the delivery schedule data can be provided to the camera from a device associated with the resident **116**. For example, the mobile device **115** may receive, from a delivery service, a text message or email indicating an expected delivery time for the first delivery. In some examples, the mobile device **115** can be configured to forward the text message or email to the camera **104**. In some examples, the camera **104** can be configured to intercept the text message or email that is sent to the mobile device **115**.

[0057] In some examples, the blindspot delivery detector **146** can determine that the package **110** has been delivered to a blindspot based on historical delivery data. For example, a historical delivery database **162** can store data indicating historical package delivery locations. The historical package delivery locations can be determined, for example, based on historical camera image data and user feedback.

[0058] As an example, the blindspot delivery detector **146** may determine, based on camera image data, that a package has been delivered to the location **118** at the property **102**. The blindspot

delivery detector **146** can then provide a delivery notification **160** to the resident **116**. In some examples, the delivery notification **160** can indicate an estimated delivery location of the package. For example, the delivery notification **160** can include text stating that the package has been delivered to the location **118**, which may be described as being on the ground on the southwest side of the porch **111**.

[0059] In some examples, the delivery notification **160** can include a request for feedback on the accuracy of the estimated delivery location. For example, the delivery notification **160** can cause the mobile device **115** to display text asking if the estimated delivery location is accurate. The resident **116** can provide information, e.g., through a user interface of the mobile device **115**, indicating whether the estimated delivery location is accurate or inaccurate. If the resident **116** indicates that the estimated delivery location is inaccurate, the resident **116** can provide information to the camera **104** indicating an actual delivery location of the package. In some examples, the resident can provide information to the camera **104** indicating the actual delivery location of the package by capturing an image of the package, e.g., using a camera of the mobile device **115**. The photograph can be provided to the camera **104**, e.g., by being uploaded through a mobile application operating on the mobile device **115**. The camera **104** can update the historical delivery database **162** using the feedback received from the resident **116** indicating the actual delivery location of the package.

[0060] In some examples, the historical delivery database **162** can store a data entry for each past delivery, with each entry including a time of the delivery and a location of the delivery. The historical delivery database **162** can include data indicating whether each delivery was delivered to a blindspot or to a location that is not in a blindspot.

[0061] The blindspot delivery detector **146** can determine, based on data in the historical delivery database **162**, common or frequent delivery locations that are blindspots. For example, the blindspot delivery detector **146** can determine, based on data in the historical delivery database **162**, that packages are frequently delivered to the location **118**.

[0062] When the delivery person **114** approaches the property **102**, the blindspot delivery detector **146** can track movement of the delivery person **114** and determine that the delivery person **114** carries the package **110** along path **113** to a location that is outside of the field of view of the camera **104**. The blindspot delivery detector **146** can determine, based on the scene model **144**, that the path **113** leads towards the location **118**. The blindspot delivery detector **146** can determine, based on the data in the historical delivery database **162**, that the location **118** is a common package delivery location. The blindspot delivery detector **146** can then estimate that the package **110** has been delivered to the location **118**.

[0063] In another example, an area **117** of the porch **111** that is near to the door **103** may be in a blindspot of the camera **104**. The scene model **144** can include data identifying the area **117** of the porch **111** near to the door **103** as a location where, historically, packages have been delivered. The scene model **144** can also include data identifying the area **117** as a blindspot. The blindspot delivery detector **146** can determine, based on the first set of images **126**, that the delivery person **114** has approached the door **103**, entered the area **117** of the porch **111**, and then departed from the property **102**. The blindspot delivery detector can then determine, based on the delivery person **114** entering the area **117**, that the delivery person **114** has delivered the package **110** to the blindspot of the area **117** of the porch **111**.

[0064] In some examples, the blindspot delivery detector **146** can determine that the package **110** was delivered to a location that is outside of the field of view of the camera **104** based on the camera **104** capturing images indicating that a delivery occurred. For example, the delivery person **114** may walk through the field of view of the camera **104** at 10:30 am along path **113** and place the package **110** in the location **118** that is outside of the field of view of the camera **104**.

[0065] In some examples, the blindspot delivery detector **146** can determine that the package **110** was delivered to a location that is outside of the field of view of the camera **104** based on a delivery

image that is captured by the delivery person **114** and forwarded or intercepted by the camera **104**. For example, the camera **104** can compare the delivery image to the scene model **144** to confirm that the package **110** was delivered to the correct property, and to determine a location within the delivery scene where the package **110** was delivered. Thus, the camera **104** can determine that a blindspot delivery occurred even in cases where the delivery person **114**, the package **110**, or both, are never visible camera **104**.

[0066] In some cases, first set of images **126** may show the delivery person **114** carrying the package **110** while approaching the property **102**, and not carrying the package **110** while retreating from the property **102**. The camera **104** can analyze the first set of images **126** to determine, based on the delivery person **114** walking through the field of view of the camera **104** at 10:30 am, that a delivery event likely occurred at or near 10:30 am.

[0067] The blindspot delivery detector **146** detects that the package **110** has been delivered to a blindspot of the camera **104** based on comparing the first set of images **126** to the scene model **144**. The blindspot delivery detector **146** can provide a delivery notification **160** to the mobile device **115** indicating that the package **110** was delivered to the property **102**. In some examples, the delivery notification **160** can indicate that the package **110** was delivered to a blindspot of the camera **104**.

[0068] The mobile device **115** receives the delivery notification **160**. The delivery notification can include, for example, an electronic mail communication, a text message, a push notification, etc. The delivery notification can include information related to the delivery. The delivery notification can also include an image of the delivered package **110**, e.g., at least one image of first set of images **126**.

[0069] In some examples, in response to determining that a package was delivered to a blindspot of installed cameras, the camera **104** can perform one or more actions to monitor the package. For example, the camera **104** may reposition itself in order to capture images of the package. The camera **104** can reposition itself by changing its articulation and/or telescoping. In some examples, the camera **104** can change its position to see around an occlusion such as the shrub **122**. For example, the camera **104** can raise, lower, or pivot.

[0070] In some examples, the environment **100** includes a second camera, e.g., roof-mounted camera **105**. The roof-mounted camera **105** can be mounted to a rail **108** that runs the length of the roof of the property. For example, the rail **108** may run next to or on top of the roof ridge. In some examples, the roof-mounted camera can be mounted to a rail **108** that runs alongside a gutter or that is mounted to an cave or wall of the property **102**. The roof-mounted camera **105** can move back and forth along the rail **108**, e.g., as directed by the camera **104** in order to capture images of the package **110**. In some cases, the roof-mounted camera **105** can patrol along the rail **108** autonomously until the camera **105** detects an object of interest.

[0071] In some examples, the system can include one or more robots, e.g., ground or aerial robots, such as the robot **106**. In some examples, the robot **106** may include data capture and recording devices. For example, the robot **106** may include one or more cameras. In some examples, the robot **106** may include a communication module. The communication module can enable the robot **106** to communicate with, for example, a GPS satellite system, the monitoring server, the camera **104**, other robots, and other devices, e.g., the mobile device **115**. The communication module can be a wireless communication module that allows the robot **106** to communicate wirelessly. The camera **104** can transmit an instruction that causes the robot **106** to maneuver to a position where the mounted cameras can capture images of the package **110**.

[0072] In some examples, the camera **104** can direct the roof-mounted camera **105**, the robot **106**, or both, to capture images of areas where deliveries are likely to occur, e.g., based on data stored in the historical delivery database **162**. In some examples, the camera **104** can direct the roof-mounted camera **105** and/or the robot **106** to follow a target that the camera **104** determines is heading in the direction of a blindspot. For example, when the delivery person **114** departs from walkway **125**

along path **113**, the camera **104** can determine that the delivery person **114** is likely heading out of the field of view of the camera **104**. The camera **104** can thus transmit instructions to at least one of the roof-mounted camera **105** or the robot **106** to track the delivery person. In some examples, upon determining that the package **110** has been delivered to a blindspot, the camera **104** can direct the roof-mounted camera **105**, the robot **106**, or both to monitor the package **110** until the package **110** is retrieved, e.g., by the resident **116**. In some examples, images captured by the roof-mounted camera **105** and images captured by the robot **106** are transmitted to the camera **104** for image analysis and blindspot delivery detection.

[0073] The blindspot delivery detector **146** can output data indicating the blindspot delivery detection **148** to the AOI generator **150**. The data indicating the blindspot delivery detection **148** can include, for example, a determination that a blindspot delivery has occurred, an estimated delivery location, a time of delivery, a size of the package, etc. In some examples, the blindspot delivery detection **148** can include a confidence value associated with the determination that the blindspot delivery has occurred and a confidence value associated with the estimated delivery location.

[0074] For example, the blindspot delivery detector **146** may determine a higher confidence value for the determination that the blindspot delivery has occurred based on camera image data showing the delivery person **114** carrying the package **110** while approaching the property **102**, and not carrying the package **110** while departing from the property **102**. The blindspot delivery detector **146** may determine a lower confidence value based on the package **110** not ever being visible to the camera **104**.

[0075] The AOI generator **150** generates an AOI **152** based on the blindspot delivery detection **148**. The AOI **152** is an area that is designated for the camera **104** to monitor. For example, the AOI **152** can include a guard perimeter around the estimated location of the package. The camera **104** can track movement in to and out of the guard perimeter in order to monitor the package.

[0076] In some examples, the AOI generator **150** can store pre-generated AOIs **152**. For example, the scene model **144** can include data identifying the area **117** of the porch **111** as a blindspot. The AOI generator **150** can store a pre-generated AOI for guarding packages that are delivered to the area **117**. The pre-generated AOI can be bounded by boundary **119**. When the camera **104** determines that a package has been delivered to the area **117**, the AOI generator **150** can generate an AOI **152** that includes a virtual line crossing in the camera field of view, where the virtual line crossing corresponds to the boundary **119**.

[0077] In some examples, the AOI generator **150** can generate a custom AOI based on the blindspot delivery detection. For example, the AOI generator **150** may generate a larger AOI **152** for monitoring a larger package, and a smaller AOI **152** for monitoring a smaller package. Similarly, the AOI generator **150** may generate a larger AOI **152** when the blindspot delivery detection **148** includes a lower confidence value for the estimated delivery location, and a smaller AOI **152** when the blindspot delivery detection **148** includes a higher confidence value for the estimated delivery locations.

[0078] The AOI **152** can include a virtual line crossing, or tripwire, in the camera field of view. In the example of FIG. 1, the blindspot delivery detection **148** indicates that the package **110** was delivered to the location **118**. The location **118** is located to the southwest side of the porch **111**, which corresponds to the right side of the porch **111** from the perspective of the camera **104**. The where the virtual line crossing corresponds to the boundary **119**.

[0079] The AOI generator **150** generates an AOI **152** that includes a virtual line crossing **130**. The virtual line crossing **130** establishes a boundary around the estimated location of the package **110**, such that a person in the field of view of the camera **104** would likely need to cross the virtual line crossing **130** in order to interfere with the package **110** at the location **118**.

[0080] In some examples, the AOI generator **150** can generate the AOI **152** based on the scene model **144**. For example, the AOI generator **150** may determine, based on the scene model **144**,

that the package **110** has been delivered to a location where there are few paths to approach the package **110**. For example, the package **110** may be bounded on a first side by a wall of the property **102**, on a second and third side by trees. Thus, the AOI generator **150** can determine that a person interfering with the package would likely approach from a fourth side that is accessible to the person. The AOI generator **150** can therefore generate the AOI **152** to detect a person approaching from the fourth side.

[0081] In another example, the AOI generator **150** may determine, based on the scene model **144**, that the package **110** has been delivered to a location where there are many paths to approach the package **110**. For example, the package **110** may be delivered to a location in the front yard that is occluded from the camera **104** by the shrub **122** and that is accessible from multiple directions of approach. The multiple directions can include, for example, approaching from a street **123**, approaching from the walkway **125**, and approaching from a neighboring yard to the left from the perspective of the camera **104**.

[0082] In some cases, the AOI generator **150** can generate an AOI **152** that bounds the package from each of the multiple directions of approach. In some cases, the AOI generator **150** can generate an AOI **152** that bounds the package from the most likely direction or directions of approach. For example, based on the scene model **144**, the AOI generator **150** may determine that the most likely direction of approach for an interferer is from a street **123**. Therefore, the AOI generator **150** can generate an AOI that includes a boundary between the estimated package location and the street **123**. In another example, based on the scene model **144**, the AOI generator **150** may determine that the package **110** is most likely to be visible from the walkway **125**, and therefore that the most likely direction of approach for an interferer is from the walkway **125**. Therefore, the AOI generator **150** can generate an AOI **152** that includes a boundary between the estimated package location and the walkway **125**. In some examples, the AOI generator **150** can determine a size and/or shape of the AOI **152** based on the likely directions of approach. For example, the AOI generator **150** may generate an AOI that has a first boundary between the street **123** and the estimated package location, and a second boundary between the walkway **125** and the estimated package location. The first boundary may be nearer to the estimated package location than the second boundary, based on the likelihood of approach from the walkway **125** being higher than the likelihood of approach from the street **123**.

[0083] In some examples, the virtual line crossing **130** triggers a package interference detection event when an object crosses the virtual line crossing **130**. In some examples, a package interference detection event is triggered when an object is detected on the same side of the virtual line crossing as the package. In some examples, a package interference is detected when an object is detected within a specified proximity to the virtual line crossing **130**. For example, the virtual line crossing **130** may be positioned such that when an object traverses the virtual line crossing **130**, the object is no longer within the field of view of the camera **104**. The camera **104** can detect package interference based on the object approaching within a specified proximity to the virtual line crossing **130**.

[0084] In some examples, the AOI **152** can include a path to the estimated location of the package. For example, a package may be delivered to a bottom of a staircase that is outside of the field of view of the camera. Based on the scene model **144**, the AOI generator **150** may determine that in order to retrieve the package, a person would need to descend the staircase. Thus, the AOI generator **150** can generate an AOI **152** that includes a descending path along the length of the staircase towards the estimated delivery location. In some examples, the AOI generator **150** can generate an AOI **152** that includes a boundary at the top of the staircase, where the boundary extends the width of the staircase. Thus, a person will cross the boundary before descending the staircase, triggering an interference detection.

[0085] In some examples, in response to determining that a package was delivered to a blindspot of installed cameras, the camera **104** can set up one or more rules to monitor for actions that are

associated with package tampering or package pickup. For example, the camera **104** can set up a rule that monitors for images of a person crouching, bending, or squatting near the estimated package location. In another example, the camera **104** can set up a rule that monitors for images of a person lingering near the estimated package location for a duration of time. For example, the camera **104** can set up a rule that monitors for a person remaining in the AOI **152** for at least a threshold duration of time.

[0086] The camera **104** can establish more strict rules when the property is in a higher traffic area in order to reduce the likelihood of false alarms, and can establish less strict rules when the property is in a lower traffic area. For example, in a lower traffic area, the camera **104** can set up a less strict rule that triggers a delivery interference detection when any person is detected within the AOI **152**. In a higher traffic area, the camera **104** can set up a stricter rule that triggers a delivery interference detection when a person is detected within the AOI **152** for at least a threshold duration of five seconds.

[0087] In some examples, the camera **104** can adjust blindspot monitoring rules over time. For example, the camera **104** may receive feedback from the resident **116** indicating that a delivery interference notification was a false alarm. Based on the feedback, the camera **104** can adjust the rules to be stricter, in order to reduce the frequency of false alarms. In some examples, the camera **104** can adjust the rules based on analyzing captured image data over time. For example, the camera **104** may determine, based on image analysis performed over time, that an average of three people per hour pass through the AOI **152** and are within the AOI **152** for an average of two seconds. Thus, the camera **104** can establish a rule that triggers a delivery interference notification **156** when a person lingers within the AOI **152** for four seconds or greater.

[0088] In some examples, in response to determining that a package was delivered to a blindspot of installed cameras, the camera **104** can set up one or more temporary rules to increase a level of monitoring, e.g., by lowering thresholds for obtaining additional data or for generating notifications. For example, the camera **104** can set up a rule that causes the camera **104** to record video if the camera **104** captures images of any person entering or exiting the AOI **152**. In another example, the camera **104** can set up a rule that causes the camera **104** to generate a notification if the camera **104** captures images of any person entering or exiting the AOI **152**.

[0089] The AOI generator **150** and provides the AOI **152** to the blindspot monitor **154**. The blindspot monitor **154** monitors the package while the package is located in the blindspot.

[0090] The blindspot monitor **154** can monitor and track the package **110** using the second set of images **136**. For example, after delivery of the package **110**, the camera **104** can continue to capture images. In some examples, the camera **104** continuously captures images. In some examples, the camera **104** captures images in response to detecting motion and/or detecting an object of interest.

[0091] The blindspot monitor **154** can monitor the second set of images **136** for depictions of people in the AOI and/or for people crossing over the virtual line crossing **130**. For example, the second set of images **136** includes image **134**. Image **134** shows a person **140** departing within the AOI defined by the virtual line crossing **130**. The second set of images **136** may include images of the person **140** entering the AOI, exiting the AOI, or both.

[0092] In some examples, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine that delivery interference has occurred based on detecting the person **140** in the AOI. Delivery interference can include, for example, a non-resident person moving, removing, or damaging the package **110**. In some examples, upon detecting the person **140** in the blindspot monitor **154** can perform additional analysis in order to determine whether delivery interference has occurred.

[0093] In some examples, the blindspot monitor **154** can perform additional analysis by performing facial recognition on the person **140**. For example, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine whether any images of the second set of images includes a view of the person's face. The blindspot monitor **154** can then perform facial recognition in order to identify the person **140** and/or to determine whether the person **140** is a resident of the property **102**. In some examples, in response

to determining that the person **140** is within the AOI and is not a resident of the property **102**, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine that delivery interference has occurred.

[0094] In some examples, the blindspot monitor **154** can perform additional analysis by analyzing images of the person **140** and/or a vehicle operated by the person **140**. For example, person **140** may be a second delivery person who is delivering a second package. The blindspot monitor **154** can analyze the second set of images **136** to determine whether the person **140** is wearing a delivery uniform or is driving a delivery truck. Additionally, the blindspot monitor **154** can analyze the second set of images **136** to determine whether the person **140** approached the property **102** carrying a second package. In some examples, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine whether the approach of the person **140** corresponds to any expected deliveries, e.g., as specified by the delivery schedule data **165**. Based on determining that the person **140** is a second delivery person delivering a second package, the blindspot monitor **154** may determine that no delivery interference has occurred.

[0095] In some examples, the blindspot monitor **154** can analyze the second set of images **136** to determine if the person **140** departs from the property **102** carrying the package **110**. For example, the camera **104** can store an image of the package **110** if the package **110** was visible to the camera **104** in the first set of images **126**. When the person **140** departs from the property **102**, the camera **104** can compare a package in the second set of images **136** to the package **110** detected in the first set of images **126** to determine whether the person **140** has stolen the package **110**.

[0096] The blindspot monitor **154** can analyze the second set of images **136** to determine whether the person **140** is a resident of the property or another person who is authorized to pick up the package **110**. For example, the blindspot monitor **154** can perform facial recognition to determine whether the person **140** is a resident of the property **102**.

[0097] In some examples, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine that the person **140** is a resident of the property **102** based on receiving data indicating a location of a mobile device of the resident, e.g., the mobile device **115** of the resident **116**. For example, the camera **104** can determine the location of the mobile device **115** based on GPS data indicating the location of the mobile device **115** and/or based on communicating with the mobile device **115** via short range communication. The camera **104** can determine that the person **140** is the resident **116** based on comparing the location of the mobile device **115** with the location of the person **140**. In some examples, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine that the person **140** is the resident **116** based on access controls, e.g., the person **140** entering an access code to a control panel of a system of the property **102**.

[0098] In some examples, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine that the person **140** is the resident **116** based on receiving a confirmation of package pickup from the resident **116**. For example, the resident **116** can submit, e.g., through an application of the mobile device **115**, a confirmation that the resident **116** has picked up the package **110**. In some examples, based on detecting the person **140** within the AOI **152**, the blindspot monitor **154** can transmit, to the mobile device **115**, a request for confirmation that an authorized person has picked up the package **110**. The resident **116** can respond to the request by indicating “yes” an authorized person has picked up the package or “no” an authorized person has not picked up the package **110**.

[0099] In some examples, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine whether package interference has occurred in part based on a path taken by the person **140**. For example, based on the person **140** entering the AOI **152** and then approaching the door **103**, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine that no delivery interference has occurred. In contrast, based on the person **140** entering the AOI **152** and then walking towards the street **123**, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine that delivery interference has occurred.

[0100] In response to determining that the person **140** is a resident of the property **102** or another authorized person, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine that no delivery interference has occurred. The blindspot monitor **154** can cease performing blindspot monitoring when the

blindspot monitor **154** determines that the package **110** has been picked up by a resident, has been moved into the field of view of the camera **104**, and/or has been brought inside the property **102**. [0101] In some examples, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine that delivery interference is likely to occur, and can perform actions to prevent the delivery interference from occurring. For example, the second set of images can include images of the person **140** approaching the virtual line crossing **130**. When the blindspot monitor **154** detects the person **140** crossing the virtual line crossing **130**, the blindspot monitor **154** can transmit a command to a device at the property **102** to generate a warning for the person **140**.

[0102] As an example, a light may be located near the porch **111**. The blindspot monitor **154** can transmit a command to the light that causes the light to flash, as a warning for the person **140**. In another example, an audio speaker may be located near the porch **111**. The blindspot monitor **154** can transmit a command to the audio speaker that causes the audio speaker to broadcast sound. The sound can include, for example, an alarm sound or a voice that warns the person **140**. In some examples, in response to determining that delivery interference is likely to occur, the blindspot monitor **154** can transmit a pre-emptive notification to the mobile device **115**.

[0103] In some examples, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine that delivery interference is likely to occur or has occurred, and can adjust settings of the camera **104**. For example, based on determining that delivery interference is likely to occur, the blindspot monitor **154** can increase a length of video clip captured by the camera **104** and/or can increase frequency of images captured by the camera **104**.

[0104] In the example of FIG. 1, based on the second set of images **136** showing the person **140** in the AOI, the blindspot monitor **154** determines that delivery interference has occurred. The blindspot monitor **154** transmits a delivery interference notification **156**. The delivery interference notification **156** can be transmitted to a computing device associated with a resident of the property **102**, e.g., the mobile device **115** associated with the resident **116**. The blindspot monitor **154** can send the delivery interference notification **156** to the mobile device **115**, e.g., over a long-range data link. The delivery interference notification **156** can indicate that that package **110** has been interfered with.

[0105] In some examples, the blindspot monitor **154** can transmit a delivery interference notification **156** to more than one resident. For example, three residents may be associated with the property **102**. The blindspot monitor **154** can transmit the delivery interference notification **156** to each of the three residents.

[0106] In some examples, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine, based on camera images showing the person **140** carrying the package **110**, that the person **140** has stolen the package **110**. The delivery interference notification **156** can therefore indicate to the resident **116** that the package **110** has likely been stolen.

[0107] In some examples, the delivery interference notification **156** can include prompts for the resident **116** to provide a confirmation that the package was picked up by a resident, or that the package was not picked up by a resident. For example, the delivery interference notification **156** can cause the mobile device **115** to display a user interface to the resident **116**. The user interface can include selectable icons, e.g., a selectable icon indicating that “yes” the package was picked up by a resident or “no” the package was not picked up by a resident. After transmitting the delivery interference notification **156** to the resident, **116**, the camera **104** can receive data indicating the resident's selection.

[0108] Though described above as being performed by a particular component of a system in the environment **100** (e.g., the camera **104** or the camera), and any of the various control, processing, and analysis operations can be performed by either the camera **104** or another component of the system. For example, the system may include a control unit at the property **102**. The control unit may be configured to monitor and control various sensors and devices at the property **102**. The control unit may communicate with the camera **104** and other sensors over a wireless network at

the property **102**. The control unit, the camera **104**, or another computer system can analyze images to monitor deliveries at the property **102**.

[0109] The system is an example of a system implemented as computer programs on one or more computers in one or more locations, in which the systems, components, and techniques described in this specification are implemented. The user devices including mobile device **115** and others not depicted in FIG. **1** can include personal computers, mobile communication devices, and other devices that can send and receive data over a network. The network (not shown), such as a local area network (“LAN”), wide area network (“WAN”), the Internet, or a combination thereof, connects the user devices including the mobile device **115**, the camera **104**, and the devices not depicted in FIG. **1**. The system can use a single server computer or multiple server computers operating in conjunction with one another, including, for example, a set of remote computers deployed as a cloud computing service.

[0110] The system can include several different functional components, including a blindspot delivery detector **146**, an AOI generator **150**, and a blindspot monitor **154**. The blindspot delivery detector **146**, the AOI generator **150**, or the blindspot monitor **154**, or a combination of these, can include one or more data processing apparatuses, can be implemented in code, or a combination of both. For instance, each of the blindspot delivery detector **146**, an AOI generator **150**, and a blindspot monitor **154** can include one or more data processors and instructions that cause the one or more data processors to perform the operations discussed herein.

[0111] The various functional components of the system can be installed on one or more computers as separate functional components or as different modules of a same functional component. For example, the components blindspot delivery detector **146**, AOI generator **150**, and blindspot monitor **154** of the system can be implemented as computer programs installed on one or more computers in one or more locations that are coupled to each through a network. In cloud-based systems for example, these components can be implemented by individual computing nodes of a distributed computing system.

[0112] FIG. **2** is a flow diagram of an example process **200** for monitoring packages delivered to camera blindspots. Briefly, the process **200** includes detecting, using one or more images captured by a camera at a property, movement in an area of interest at the property that is included in a field of view of the camera and was generated using historical data for packages delivered to the property (**202**), determining, using the detected movement in the area of interest, that a package was likely delivered (**204**), and in response to determining that the package was likely delivered, performing one or more automated actions for the package (**206**)

[0113] In additional detail, the process **200** includes detecting, using one or more images captured by a camera at a property, movement in an area of interest at the property that is included in a field of view of the camera and was generated using historical data for packages delivered to the property (**202**). For example, the blindspot delivery detector **146** can detect delivery of the package **110** to the location **118** that is outside of the field of view of the camera **104** at the property **102**. The blindspot delivery detector **146** can detect the package delivery to the location **118** based on analyzing the first set of images **126** that show the delivery person **114** following path **113**. The blindspot delivery detector can compare the first set of images **126** to the scene model **144** and to historical delivery database **162** to determine that the package **110** was likely delivered to the location **118**.

[0114] In some examples, the process **200** can detect the movement using data other than image data, e.g., alone or in conjunction with the use of image data. For instance, the blindspot delivery detector **146** can use motion sensor data, near field communication data from a delivery person's device, weight sensor data for a weight sensor at the location outside the camera **104**'s field of view, other appropriate sensor data, or a combination of two or more of these to detect delivery of the package **110**.

[0115] The process **200** can include, generating an area of interest in the camera field of view. The

process **200** can perform the generation in response to detecting the package delivery to the location that is outside the camera field of view. For example, based on the blindspot delivery detection **148** indicating package delivery to the location **118**, the AOI generator **150** can generate the AOI **152**. The AOI **152** is defined by virtual line crossing **130** in the field of view of the camera **104**.

[0116] The process **200** can include monitoring the area of interest using camera images captured by the camera. For example, the blindspot monitor **154** can monitor the area of interest bounded by the virtual line crossing **130** using the second set of images **136**. The blindspot monitor **154** can monitor activity inside the area of interest as well as objects crossing in to or out of the area of interest.

[0117] The process **200** includes determining, using the detected movement in the area of interest, that a package was likely delivered (**204**). For example, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine that package delivery interference has occurred based on detecting, in the second set of images **136**, the person **140** inside the area of interest. In some examples, the blindspot monitor **154** can determine that the package delivery interference has occurred based on determining that the person **140** is not a resident of the property **102** and is not a delivery person.

[0118] The process **200** includes, in response to determining that the package was likely delivered, performing one or more automated actions for the package (**206**). For example, based on determining that package delivery interference has occurred, the blindspot monitor **154** can provide the delivery interference notification **156** to the mobile device **115** for presentation to the resident **116**.

[0119] FIG. **3** is a diagram illustrating an example of a home monitoring system **300**. The monitoring system **300** includes a network **305**, a control unit **310**, one or more user devices **340** and **350**, a monitoring server **360**, and a central alarm station server **370**. In some examples, the network **305** facilitates communications between the control unit **310**, the one or more user devices **340** and **350**, the monitoring server **360**, and the central alarm station server **370**.

[0120] The network **305** is configured to enable exchange of electronic communications between devices connected to the network **305**. For example, the network **305** may be configured to enable exchange of electronic communications between the control unit **310**, the one or more user devices **340** and **350**, the monitoring server **360**, and the central alarm station server **370**. The network **305** may include, for example, one or more of the Internet, Wide Area Networks (WANs), Local Area Networks (LANs), analog or digital wired and wireless telephone networks (e.g., a public switched telephone network (PSTN), Integrated Services Digital Network (ISDN), a cellular network, and Digital Subscriber Line (DSL)), radio, television, cable, satellite, or any other delivery or tunneling mechanism for carrying data. Network **305** may include multiple networks or subnetworks, each of which may include, for example, a wired or wireless data pathway. The network **305** may include a circuit-switched network, a packet-switched data network, or any other network able to carry electronic communications (e.g., data or voice communications). For example, the network **305** may include networks based on the Internet protocol (IP), asynchronous transfer mode (ATM), the PSTN, packet-switched networks based on IP, X.25, or Frame Relay, or other comparable technologies and may support voice using, for example, VoIP, or other comparable protocols used for voice communications. The network **305** may include one or more networks that include wireless data channels and wireless voice channels. The network **305** may be a wireless network, a broadband network, or a combination of networks including a wireless network and a broadband network.

[0121] The control unit **310** includes a controller **312** and a network module **314**. The controller **312** is configured to control a control unit monitoring system (e.g., a control unit system) that includes the control unit **310**. In some examples, the controller **312** may include a processor or other control circuitry configured to execute instructions of a program that controls operation of a control unit system. In these examples, the controller **312** may be configured to receive input from

sensors, flow meters, or other devices included in the control unit system and control operations of devices included in the household (e.g., speakers, lights, doors, etc.). For example, the controller **312** may be configured to control operation of the network module **314** included in the control unit **310**.

[0122] The network module **314** is a communication device configured to exchange communications over the network **305**. The network module **314** may be a wireless communication module configured to exchange wireless communications over the network **305**. For example, the network module **314** may be a wireless communication device configured to exchange communications over a wireless data channel and a wireless voice channel. In this example, the network module **314** may transmit alarm data over a wireless data channel and establish a two-way voice communication session over a wireless voice channel. The wireless communication device may include one or more of a LTE module, a GSM module, a radio modem, cellular transmission module, or any type of module configured to exchange communications in one of the following formats: LTE, GSM or GPRS, CDMA, EDGE or EGPRS, EV-DO or EVDO, UMTS, or IP.

[0123] The network module **314** also may be a wired communication module configured to exchange communications over the network **305** using a wired connection. For instance, the network module **314** may be a modem, a network interface card, or another type of network interface device. The network module **314** may be an Ethernet network card configured to enable the control unit **310** to communicate over a local area network and/or the Internet. The network module **314** also may be a voice band modem configured to enable the alarm panel to communicate over the telephone lines of Plain Old Telephone Systems (POTS).

[0124] The control unit system that includes the control unit **310** includes one or more sensors. For example, the monitoring system may include multiple sensors **320**. The sensors **320** may include a lock sensor, a contact sensor, a motion sensor, or any other type of sensor included in a control unit system. The sensors **320** also may include an environmental sensor, such as a temperature sensor, a water sensor, a rain sensor, a wind sensor, a light sensor, a smoke detector, a carbon monoxide detector, an air quality sensor, etc. The sensors **320** further may include a health monitoring sensor, such as a prescription bottle sensor that monitors taking of prescriptions, a blood pressure sensor, a blood sugar sensor, a bed mat configured to sense presence of liquid (e.g., bodily fluids) on the bed mat, etc. In some examples, the health-monitoring sensor can be a wearable sensor that attaches to a user in the home. The health-monitoring sensor can collect various health data, including pulse, heart rate, respiration rate, sugar or glucose level, bodily temperature, or motion data.

[0125] The sensors **320** can also include a radio-frequency identification (RFID) sensor that identifies a particular article that includes a pre-assigned RFID tag.

[0126] The control unit **310** communicates with the home automation controls **322** and a camera **330** to perform monitoring. The home automation controls **322** are connected to one or more devices that enable automation of actions in the home. For instance, the home automation controls **322** may be connected to one or more lighting systems and may be configured to control operation of the one or more lighting systems. In addition, the home automation controls **322** may be connected to one or more electronic locks at the home and may be configured to control operation of the one or more electronic locks (e.g., control Z-Wave locks using wireless communications in the Z-Wave protocol). Further, the home automation controls **322** may be connected to one or more appliances at the home and may be configured to control operation of the one or more appliances. The home automation controls **322** may include multiple modules that are each specific to the type of device being controlled in an automated manner. The home automation controls **322** may control the one or more devices based on commands received from the control unit **310**. For instance, the home automation controls **322** may cause a lighting system to illuminate an area to provide a better image of the area when captured by a camera **330**.

[0127] The camera **330** may be a video/photographic camera or other type of optical sensing device configured to capture images. For instance, the camera **330** may be configured to capture images of

an area within a building or home monitored by the control unit **310**. The camera **330** may be configured to capture single, static images of the area and also video images of the area in which multiple images of the area are captured at a relatively high frequency (e.g., thirty images per second). The camera **330** may be controlled based on commands received from the control unit **310**.

[0128] The camera **330** may be triggered by several different types of techniques. For instance, a Passive Infra-Red (PIR) motion sensor may be built into the camera **330** and used to trigger the camera **330** to capture one or more images when motion is detected. The camera **330** also may include a microwave motion sensor built into the camera and used to trigger the camera **330** to capture one or more images when motion is detected. The camera **330** may have a “normally open” or “normally closed” digital input that can trigger capture of one or more images when external sensors (e.g., the sensors **320**, PIR, door/window, etc.) detect motion or other events. In some implementations, the camera **330** receives a command to capture an image when external devices detect motion or another potential alarm event. The camera **330** may receive the command from the controller **312** or directly from one of the sensors **320**.

[0129] In some examples, the camera **330** triggers integrated or external illuminators (e.g., Infra-Red, Z-wave controlled “white” lights, lights controlled by the home automation controls **322**, etc.) to improve image quality when the scene is dark. An integrated or separate light sensor may be used to determine if illumination is desired and may result in increased image quality.

[0130] The camera **330** may be programmed with any combination of time/day schedules, system “arming state”, or other variables to determine whether images should be captured or not when triggers occur. The camera **330** may enter a low-power mode when not capturing images. In this case, the camera **330** may wake periodically to check for inbound messages from the controller **312**. The camera **330** may be powered by internal, replaceable batteries if located remotely from the control unit **310**. The camera **330** may employ a small solar cell to recharge the battery when light is available. Alternatively, the camera **330** may be powered by the controller's **312** power supply if the camera **330** is co-located with the controller **312**.

[0131] In some implementations, the camera **330** communicates directly with the monitoring server **360** over the Internet. In these implementations, image data captured by the camera **330** does not pass through the control unit **310** and the camera **330** receives commands related to operation from the monitoring server **360**.

[0132] The system **300** also includes thermostat **334** to perform dynamic environmental control at the home. The thermostat **334** is configured to monitor temperature and/or energy consumption of an HVAC system associated with the thermostat **334**, and is further configured to provide control of environmental (e.g., temperature) settings. In some implementations, the thermostat **334** can additionally or alternatively receive data relating to activity at a home and/or environmental data at a home, e.g., at various locations indoors and outdoors at the home. The thermostat **334** can directly measure energy consumption of the HVAC system associated with the thermostat, or can estimate energy consumption of the HVAC system associated with the thermostat **334**, for example, based on detected usage of one or more components of the HVAC system associated with the thermostat **334**. The thermostat **334** can communicate temperature and/or energy monitoring information to or from the control unit **310** and can control the environmental (e.g., temperature) settings based on commands received from the control unit **310**.

[0133] In some implementations, the thermostat **334** is a dynamically programmable thermostat and can be integrated with the control unit **310**. For example, the dynamically programmable thermostat **334** can include the control unit **310**, e.g., as an internal component to the dynamically programmable thermostat **334**. In addition, the control unit **310** can be a gateway device that communicates with the dynamically programmable thermostat **334**. In some implementations, the thermostat **334** is controlled via one or more home automation controls **322**.

[0134] A module **337** is connected to one or more components of an HVAC system associated with

a home, and is configured to control operation of the one or more components of the HVAC system. In some implementations, the module **337** is also configured to monitor energy consumption of the HVAC system components, for example, by directly measuring the energy consumption of the HVAC system components or by estimating the energy usage of the one or more HVAC system components based on detecting usage of components of the HVAC system. The module **337** can communicate energy monitoring information and the state of the HVAC system components to the thermostat **334** and can control the one or more components of the HVAC system based on commands received from the thermostat **334**.

[0135] In some examples, the system **300** further includes one or more robotic devices **390**. The robotic devices **390** may be any type of robots that are capable of moving and taking actions that assist in home monitoring. For example, the robotic devices **390** may be capable of moving throughout a home based on automated control technology and/or user input control provided by a user. In this example, the robots may be able to fly, roll, walk, or otherwise move about the home. The robots may include helicopter type devices (e.g., quad copters), rolling helicopter type devices (e.g., roller copter devices that can fly and roll along the ground, walls, or ceiling) and land vehicle type devices (e.g., automated cars that drive around a home). In some cases, the robotic devices **390** may be devices that are intended for other purposes and merely associated with the system **300** for use in appropriate circumstances. For instance, a robotic vacuum cleaner device may be associated with the monitoring system **300** as one of the robotic devices **390** and may be controlled to take action responsive to monitoring system events.

[0136] In some examples, the robotic devices **390** automatically navigate within a home. In these examples, the robotic devices **390** include sensors and control processors that guide movement of the robotic devices **390** within the home. For instance, the robotic devices **390** may navigate within the home using one or more cameras, one or more proximity sensors, one or more gyroscopes, one or more accelerometers, one or more magnetometers, a global positioning system (GPS) unit, an altimeter, one or more sonar or laser sensors, and/or any other types of sensors that aid in navigation about a space. The robotic devices **390** may include control processors that process output from the various sensors and control the robotic devices **390** to move along a path that reaches the desired destination and avoids obstacles. In this regard, the control processors detect walls or other obstacles in the home and guide movement of the robotic devices **390** in a manner that avoids the walls and other obstacles.

[0137] In addition, the robotic devices **390** may store data that describes attributes of the home. For instance, the robotic devices **390** may store a floorplan and/or a three-dimensional model of the home that enables the robotic devices **390** to navigate the home. During initial configuration, the robotic devices **390** may receive the data describing attributes of the home, determine a frame of reference to the data (e.g., a home or reference location in the home), and navigate the home based on the frame of reference and the data describing attributes of the home. Further, initial configuration of the robotic devices **390** also may include learning of one or more navigation patterns in which a user provides input to control the robotic devices **390** to perform a specific navigation action (e.g., fly to an upstairs bedroom and spin around while capturing video and then return to a home charging base). In this regard, the robotic devices **390** may learn and store the navigation patterns such that the robotic devices **390** may automatically repeat the specific navigation actions upon a later request.

[0138] In some examples, the robotic devices **390** may include data capture and recording devices. In these examples, the robotic devices **390** may include one or more cameras, one or more motion sensors, one or more microphones, one or more biometric data collection tools, one or more temperature sensors, one or more humidity sensors, one or more air flow sensors, and/or any other types of sensors that may be useful in capturing monitoring data related to the home and users in the home. The one or more biometric data collection tools may be configured to collect biometric samples of a person in the home with or without contact of the person. For instance, the biometric

data collection tools may include a fingerprint scanner, a hair sample collection tool, a skin cell collection tool, and/or any other tool that allows the robotic devices **390** to take and store a biometric sample that can be used to identify the person (e.g., a biometric sample with DNA that can be used for DNA testing).

[0139] In some implementations, the robotic devices **390** may include output devices. In these implementations, the robotic devices **390** may include one or more displays, one or more speakers, and/or any type of output devices that allow the robotic devices **390** to communicate information to a nearby user.

[0140] The robotic devices **390** also may include a communication module that enables the robotic devices **390** to communicate with the control unit **310**, each other, and/or other devices. The communication module may be a wireless communication module that allows the robotic devices **390** to communicate wirelessly. For instance, the communication module may be a Wi-Fi module that enables the robotic devices **390** to communicate over a local wireless network at the home. The communication module further may be a 900 MHz wireless communication module that enables the robotic devices **390** to communicate directly with the control unit **310**. Other types of short-range wireless communication protocols, such as Bluetooth, Bluetooth LE, Z-wave, Zigbee, etc., may be used to allow the robotic devices **390** to communicate with other devices in the home. In some implementations, the robotic devices **390** may communicate with each other or with other devices of the system **300** through the network **305**.

[0141] The robotic devices **390** further may include processor and storage capabilities. The robotic devices **390** may include any suitable processing devices that enable the robotic devices **390** to operate applications and perform the actions described throughout this disclosure. In addition, the robotic devices **390** may include solid-state electronic storage that enables the robotic devices **390** to store applications, configuration data, collected sensor data, and/or any other type of information available to the robotic devices **390**.

[0142] The robotic devices **390** are associated with one or more charging stations. The charging stations may be located at predefined home base or reference locations in the home. The robotic devices **390** may be configured to navigate to the charging stations after completion of tasks needed to be performed for the monitoring system **300**. For instance, after completion of a monitoring operation or upon instruction by the control unit **310**, the robotic devices **390** may be configured to automatically fly to and land on one of the charging stations. In this regard, the robotic devices **390** may automatically maintain a fully charged battery in a state in which the robotic devices **390** are ready for use by the monitoring system **300**.

[0143] The charging stations may be contact based charging stations and/or wireless charging stations. For contact based charging stations, the robotic devices **390** may have readily accessible points of contact that the robotic devices **390** are capable of positioning and mating with a corresponding contact on the charging station. For instance, a helicopter type robotic device may have an electronic contact on a portion of its landing gear that rests on and mates with an electronic pad of a charging station when the helicopter type robotic device lands on the charging station. The electronic contact on the robotic device may include a cover that opens to expose the electronic contact when the robotic device is charging and closes to cover and insulate the electronic contact when the robotic device is in operation.

[0144] For wireless charging stations, the robotic devices **390** may charge through a wireless exchange of power. In these cases, the robotic devices **390** need only locate themselves closely enough to the wireless charging stations for the wireless exchange of power to occur. In this regard, the positioning needed to land at a predefined home base or reference location in the home may be less precise than with a contact based charging station. Based on the robotic devices **390** landing at a wireless charging station, the wireless charging station outputs a wireless signal that the robotic devices **390** receive and convert to a power signal that charges a battery maintained on the robotic devices **390**.

[0145] In some implementations, each of the robotic devices **390** has a corresponding and assigned charging station such that the number of robotic devices **390** equals the number of charging stations. In these implementations, the robotic devices **390** always navigate to the specific charging station assigned to that robotic device. For instance, a first robotic device may always use a first charging station and a second robotic device may always use a second charging station.

[0146] In some examples, the robotic devices **390** may share charging stations. For instance, the robotic devices **390** may use one or more community charging stations that are capable of charging multiple robotic devices **390**. The community charging station may be configured to charge multiple robotic devices **390** in parallel. The community charging station may be configured to charge multiple robotic devices **390** in serial such that the multiple robotic devices **390** take turns charging and, when fully charged, return to a predefined home base or reference location in the home that is not associated with a charger. The number of community charging stations may be less than the number of robotic devices **390**.

[0147] In addition, the charging stations may not be assigned to specific robotic devices **390** and may be capable of charging any of the robotic devices **390**. In this regard, the robotic devices **390** may use any suitable, unoccupied charging station when not in use. For instance, when one of the robotic devices **390** has completed an operation or is in need of battery charge, the control unit **310** references a stored table of the occupancy status of each charging station and instructs the robotic device to navigate to the nearest charging station that is unoccupied.

[0148] The system **300** further includes one or more integrated security devices **380**. The one or more integrated security devices may include any type of device used to provide alerts based on received sensor data. For instance, the one or more control units **310** may provide one or more alerts to the one or more integrated security input/output devices **380**. Additionally, the one or more control units **310** may receive one or more sensor data from the sensors **320** and determine whether to provide an alert to the one or more integrated security input/output devices **380**.

[0149] The sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, the thermostat **334**, and the integrated security devices **380** may communicate with the controller **312** over communication links **324**, **326**, **328**, **332**, **338**, and **384**. The communication links **324**, **326**, **328**, **332**, **338**, and **384** may be a wired or wireless data pathway configured to transmit signals from the sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, the thermostat **334**, and the integrated security devices **380** to the controller **312**. The sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, the thermostat **334**, and the integrated security devices **380** may continuously transmit sensed values to the controller **312**, periodically transmit sensed values to the controller **312**, or transmit sensed values to the controller **312** in response to a change in a sensed value.

[0150] The communication links **324**, **326**, **328**, **332**, **338**, and **384** may include a local network. The sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, the thermostat **334**, and the integrated security devices **380**, and the controller **312** may exchange data and commands over the local network. The local network may include 802.11 “Wi-Fi” wireless Ethernet (e.g., using low-power Wi-Fi chipsets), Z-Wave, Zigbee, Bluetooth, “Homeplug” or other “Powerline” networks that operate over AC wiring, and a Category 5 (CAT5) or Category 6 (CAT6) wired Ethernet network. The local network may be a mesh network constructed based on the devices connected to the mesh network.

[0151] The monitoring server **360** is an electronic device configured to provide monitoring services by exchanging electronic communications with the control unit **310**, the one or more user devices **340** and **350**, and the central alarm station server **370** over the network **305**. For example, the monitoring server **360** may be configured to monitor events generated by the control unit **310**. In this example, the monitoring server **360** may exchange electronic communications with the network module **314** included in the control unit **310** to receive information regarding events detected by the control unit **310**. The monitoring server **360** also may receive information regarding

events from the one or more user devices **340** and **350**.

[0152] In some examples, the monitoring server **360** may route alert data received from the network module **314** or the one or more user devices **340** and **350** to the central alarm station server **370**. For example, the monitoring server **360** may transmit the alert data to the central alarm station server **370** over the network **305**.

[0153] The monitoring server **360** may store sensor and image data received from the monitoring system and perform analysis of sensor and image data received from the monitoring system. Based on the analysis, the monitoring server **360** may communicate with and control aspects of the control unit **310** or the one or more user devices **340** and **350**.

[0154] The monitoring server **360** may provide various monitoring services to the system **300**. For example, the monitoring server **360** may analyze the sensor, image, and other data to determine an activity pattern of a resident of the home monitored by the system **300**. In some implementations, the monitoring server **360** may analyze the data for alarm conditions or may determine and perform actions at the home by issuing commands to one or more of the controls **322**, possibly through the control unit **310**.

[0155] The monitoring server **360** can be configured to provide information (e.g., activity patterns) related to one or more residents of the home monitored by the system **300**. For example, one or more of the sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, the thermostat **334**, and the integrated security devices **380** can collect data related to a resident including location information (e.g., if the resident is home or is not home) and provide location information to the thermostat **334**.

[0156] The central alarm station server **370** is an electronic device configured to provide alarm monitoring service by exchanging communications with the control unit **310**, the one or more user devices **340** and **350**, and the monitoring server **360** over the network **305**. For example, the central alarm station server **370** may be configured to monitor alerting events generated by the control unit **310**. In this example, the central alarm station server **370** may exchange communications with the network module **314** included in the control unit **310** to receive information regarding alerting events detected by the control unit **310**. The central alarm station server **370** also may receive information regarding alerting events from the one or more user devices **340** and **350** and/or the monitoring server **360**.

[0157] The central alarm station server **370** is connected to multiple terminals **372** and **374**. The terminals **372** and **374** may be used by operators to process alerting events. For example, the central alarm station server **370** may route alerting data to the terminals **372** and **374** to enable an operator to process the alerting data. The terminals **372** and **374** may include general-purpose computers (e.g., desktop personal computers, workstations, or laptop computers) that are configured to receive alerting data from a server in the central alarm station server **370** and render a display of information based on the alerting data. For instance, the controller **312** may control the network module **314** to transmit, to the central alarm station server **370**, alerting data indicating that a sensor **320** detected motion from a motion sensor via the sensors **320**. The central alarm station server **370** may receive the alerting data and route the alerting data to the terminal **372** for processing by an operator associated with the terminal **372**. The terminal **372** may render a display to the operator that includes information associated with the alerting event (e.g., the lock sensor data, the motion sensor data, the contact sensor data, etc.) and the operator may handle the alerting event based on the displayed information.

[0158] In some implementations, the terminals **372** and **374** may be mobile devices or devices designed for a specific function. Although FIG. 3 illustrates two terminals for brevity, actual implementations may include more (and, perhaps, many more) terminals.

[0159] The one or more authorized user devices **340** and **350** are devices that host and display user interfaces. For instance, the user device **340** is a mobile device that hosts or runs one or more native applications (e.g., the home monitoring application **342**). The user device **340** may be a cellular

phone or a non-cellular locally networked device with a display. The user device **340** may include a cell phone, a smart phone, a tablet PC, a personal digital assistant (“PDA”), or any other portable device configured to communicate over a network and display information. For example, implementations may also include Blackberry-type devices (e.g., as provided by Research in Motion), electronic organizers, iPhone-type devices (e.g., as provided by Apple), iPod devices (e.g., as provided by Apple) or other portable music players, other communication devices, and handheld or portable electronic devices for gaming, communications, and/or data organization. The user device **340** may perform functions unrelated to the monitoring system, such as placing personal telephone calls, playing music, playing video, displaying pictures, browsing the Internet, maintaining an electronic calendar, etc.

[0160] The user device **340** includes a home monitoring application **352**. The home monitoring application **342** refers to a software/firmware program running on the corresponding mobile device that enables the user interface and features described throughout. The user device **340** may load or install the home monitoring application **342** based on data received over a network or data received from local media. The home monitoring application **342** runs on mobile devices platforms, such as iPhone, iPod touch, Blackberry, Google Android, Windows Mobile, etc. The home monitoring application **342** enables the user device **340** to receive and process image and sensor data from the monitoring system.

[0161] The user device **340** may be a general-purpose computer (e.g., a desktop personal computer, a workstation, or a laptop computer) that is configured to communicate with the monitoring server **360** and/or the control unit **310** over the network **305**. The user device **340** may be configured to display a smart home user interface **352** that is generated by the user device **340** or generated by the monitoring server **360**. For example, the user device **340** may be configured to display a user interface (e.g., a web page) provided by the monitoring server **360** that enables a user to perceive images captured by the camera **330** and/or reports related to the monitoring system. Although FIG. 3 illustrates two user devices for brevity, actual implementations may include more (and, perhaps, many more) or fewer user devices.

[0162] In some implementations, the one or more user devices **340** and **350** communicate with and receive monitoring system data from the control unit **310** using the communication link **338**. For instance, the one or more user devices **340** and **350** may communicate with the control unit **310** using various local wireless protocols such as Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, Z-wave, Zigbee, HomePlug (ethernet over power line), or wired protocols such as Ethernet and USB, to connect the one or more user devices **340** and **350** to local security and automation equipment. The one or more user devices **340** and **350** may connect locally to the monitoring system and its sensors and other devices. The local connection may improve the speed of status and control communications because communicating through the network **305** with a remote server (e.g., the monitoring server **360**) may be significantly slower.

[0163] Although the one or more user devices **340** and **350** are shown as communicating with the control unit **310**, the one or more user devices **340** and **350** may communicate directly with the sensors and other devices controlled by the control unit **310**. In some implementations, the one or more user devices **340** and **350** replace the control unit **310** and perform the functions of the control unit **310** for local monitoring and long range/offsite communication.

[0164] In other implementations, the one or more user devices **340** and **350** receive monitoring system data captured by the control unit **310** through the network **305**. The one or more user devices **340**, **350** may receive the data from the control unit **310** through the network **305** or the monitoring server **360** may relay data received from the control unit **310** to the one or more user devices **340** and **350** through the network **305**. In this regard, the monitoring server **360** may facilitate communication between the one or more user devices **340** and **350** and the monitoring system.

[0165] In some implementations, the one or more user devices **340** and **350** may be configured to

switch whether the one or more user devices **340** and **350** communicate with the control unit **310** directly (e.g., through link **338**) or through the monitoring server **360** (e.g., through network **305**) based on a location of the one or more user devices **340** and **350**. For instance, when the one or more user devices **340** and **350** are located close to the control unit **310** and in range to communicate directly with the control unit **310**, the one or more user devices **340** and **350** use direct communication. When the one or more user devices **340** and **350** are located far from the control unit **310** and not in range to communicate directly with the control unit **310**, the one or more user devices **340** and **350** use communication through the monitoring server **360**.

[0166] Although the one or more user devices **340** and **350** are shown as being connected to the network **305**, in some implementations, the one or more user devices **340** and **350** are not connected to the network **305**. In these implementations, the one or more user devices **340** and **350** communicate directly with one or more of the monitoring system components and no network (e.g., Internet) connection or reliance on remote servers is needed.

[0167] In some implementations, the one or more user devices **340** and **350** are used in conjunction with only local sensors and/or local devices in a house. In these implementations, the system **300** includes the one or more user devices **340** and **350**, the sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, and the robotic devices **390**. The one or more user devices **340** and **350** receive data directly from the sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, and the robotic devices **390**, and sends data directly to the sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, and the robotic devices **390**. The one or more user devices **340**, **350** provide the appropriate interfaces/processing to provide visual surveillance and reporting.

[0168] In other implementations, the system **300** further includes network **305** and the sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, the thermostat **334**, and the robotic devices **390**, and are configured to communicate sensor and image data to the one or more user devices **340** and **350** over network **305** (e.g., the Internet, cellular network, etc.). In yet another implementation, the sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, the thermostat **334**, and the robotic devices **390** (or a component, such as a bridge/router) are intelligent enough to change the communication pathway from a direct local pathway when the one or more user devices **340** and **350** are in close physical proximity to the sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, the thermostat **334**, and the robotic devices **390** to a pathway over network **305** when the one or more user devices **340** and **350** are farther from the sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, the thermostat **334**, and the robotic devices **390**.

[0169] In some examples, the system leverages GPS information from the one or more user devices **340** and **350** to determine whether the one or more user devices **340** and **350** are close enough to the sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, the thermostat **334**, and the robotic devices **390** to use the direct local pathway or whether the one or more user devices **340** and **350** are far enough from the sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, the thermostat **334**, and the robotic devices **390** that the pathway over network **305** is required.

[0170] In other examples, the system leverages status communications (e.g., pinging) between the one or more user devices **340** and **350** and the sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, the thermostat **334**, and the robotic devices **390** to determine whether communication using the direct local pathway is possible. If communication using the direct local pathway is possible, the one or more user devices **340** and **350** communicate with the sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, the thermostat **334**, and the robotic devices **390** using the direct local pathway. If communication using the direct local pathway is not possible, the one or more user devices **340** and **350** communicate with the sensors **320**, the home automation controls **322**, the camera **330**, the thermostat **334**, and the robotic devices **390** using the pathway over network **305**.

[0171] In some implementations, the system **300** provides end users with access to images captured by the camera **330** to aid in decision making. The system **300** may transmit the images captured by

the camera **330** over a wireless WAN network to the user devices **340** and **350**. Because transmission over a wireless WAN network may be relatively expensive, the system **300** can use several techniques to reduce costs while providing access to significant levels of useful visual information (e.g., compressing data, down-sampling data, sending data only over inexpensive LAN connections, or other techniques).

[0172] In some implementations, a state of the monitoring system and other events sensed by the monitoring system may be used to enable/disable video/image recording devices (e.g., the camera **330**). In these implementations, the camera **330** may be set to capture images on a periodic basis when the alarm system is armed in an “away” state, but set not to capture images when the alarm system is armed in a “home” state or disarmed. In addition, the camera **330** may be triggered to begin capturing images when the alarm system detects an event, such as an alarm event, a door-opening event for a door that leads to an area within a field of view of the camera **330**, or motion in the area within the field of view of the camera **330**. In other implementations, the camera **330** may capture images continuously, but the captured images may be stored or transmitted over a network when needed.

[0173] The described systems, methods, and techniques may be implemented in digital electronic circuitry, computer hardware, firmware, software, or in combinations of these elements. Apparatus implementing these techniques may include appropriate input and output devices, a computer processor, and a computer program product tangibly embodied in a machine-readable storage device for execution by a programmable processor. A process implementing these techniques may be performed by a programmable processor executing a program of instructions to perform desired functions by operating on input data and generating appropriate output. The techniques may be implemented in one or more computer programs that are executable on a programmable system including at least one programmable processor coupled to receive data and instructions from, and to transmit data and instructions to, a data storage system, at least one input device, and at least one output device.

[0174] Each computer program may be implemented in a high-level procedural or object-oriented programming language, or in assembly or machine language if desired; and in any case, the language may be a compiled or interpreted language. Suitable processors include, by way of example, both general and special purpose microprocessors. Generally, a processor will receive instructions and data from a read-only memory and/or a random access memory. Storage devices suitable for tangibly embodying computer program instructions and data include all forms of non-volatile memory, including by way of example semiconductor memory devices, such as Erasable Programmable Read-Only Memory (EPROM), Electrically Erasable Programmable Read-Only Memory (EEPROM), and flash memory devices; magnetic disks such as internal hard disks and removable disks; magneto-optical disks; and Compact Disc Read-Only Memory (CD-ROM). Any of the foregoing may be supplemented by, or incorporated in, specially designed ASICs (application-specific integrated circuits).

[0175] It will be understood that various modifications may be made. For example, other useful implementations could be achieved if steps of the disclosed techniques were performed in a different order and/or if components in the disclosed systems were combined in a different manner and/or replaced or supplemented by other components. Accordingly, other implementations are within the scope of the disclosure.

Claims

1-20. (canceled)

21. A system comprising one or more computers and one or more storage devices on which are stored instructions that are operable, when executed by the one or more computers, to cause the one or more computers to perform operations comprising: maintaining, in a database, data that indicates

an area of interest that was a) generated using historical data for packages delivered to a property and b) in a field of view of a camera at the property that captured one or more first images that did not depict a location at which a first package was delivered at the property; detecting, using one or more second images captured by the camera at the property, movement in the area of interest i) at the property, ii) that is included in the field of view of the camera and iii) was generated using the historical data for packages delivered to the property; determining, using the detected movement in the area of interest and the one or more second images captured by the camera, whether a package was likely delivered; and in response to determining that the package was not likely delivered, determining to skip performing one or more automated actions for the package.

22. The system of claim 21, the operations comprising: determining that a first package was delivered to a location not depicted in the one or more first images captured by the camera at the property; and in response to determining that the first package was likely delivered to the location not depicted in the one or more first images captured by the camera at the property, generating the area of interest in the field of view of the camera.

23. The system of claim 22, wherein the location not depicted in the one or more first images captured by the camera comprises a location outside the field of view of the camera or an occluded location behind one or more objects depicted in at least the one or more first images captured by the camera.

24. The system of claim 21, wherein the one or more automated actions for the package comprises presentation of a warning when the package was likely delivered and second movement in the area of interest was detected.

25. The system of claim 21, wherein: determining, using the detected movement in the area of interest, that the package was not likely delivered comprises determining, using one or more first images from which the movement in the area of interest was detected and one or more second images a) captured by the camera after the one or more first images b) that do not depict the package, that the package was not likely delivered.

26. The system of claim 21, wherein detecting the movement in the area of interest comprises detecting, using the one or more second images captured by the camera, the movement of a person or a robot in the area of interest.

27. The system of claim 21, wherein detecting the movement in the area of interest comprises detecting, using the one or more second images captured by the camera, the movement in the area of interest around an area at which the historical data indicates one or more packages were previously delivered.

28. A computer implemented method comprising: maintaining, in a database, data that indicates an area of interest that was a) generated using historical data for packages delivered to a property and b) in a field of view of a camera at the property that captured one or more first images that did not depict a location at which a first package was delivered at the property; detecting, using one or more second images captured by the camera at the property, movement in the area of interest i) at the property, ii) that is included in the field of view of the camera and iii) was generated using the historical data for packages delivered to the property; determining, using the detected movement in the area of interest and the one or more second images captured by the camera, whether a package was likely delivered; and in response to determining that the package was not likely delivered, determining to skip performing one or more automated actions for the package.

29. The method of claim 28, comprising: determining that a first package was delivered to a location not depicted in the one or more first images captured by the camera at the property; and in response to determining that the first package was likely delivered to the location not depicted in the one or more first images captured by the camera at the property, generating the area of interest in the field of view of the camera.

30. The method of claim 29, wherein the location not depicted in the one or more first images captured by the camera comprises a location outside the field of view of the camera or an occluded

location behind one or more objects depicted in at least the one or more first images captured by the camera.

31. The method of claim 28, wherein the one or more automated actions for the package comprises presentation of a warning when the package was likely delivered and second movement in the area of interest was detected.

32. The method of claim 28, wherein: determining, using the detected movement in the area of interest, that the package was not likely delivered comprises determining, using one or more first images from which the movement in the area of interest was detected and one or more second images a) captured by the camera after the one or more first images b) that do not depict the package, that the package was not likely delivered.

33. The method of claim 28, wherein detecting the movement in the area of interest comprises detecting, using the one or more second images captured by the camera, the movement of a person or a robot in the area of interest.

34. The method of claim 28, wherein detecting the movement in the area of interest comprises detecting, using the one or more second images captured by the camera, the movement in the area of interest around an area at which the historical data indicates one or more packages were previously delivered.

35. One or more non-transitory computer storage media encoded with instructions that, when executed by one or more computers, cause the one or more computers to perform operations comprising: maintaining, in a database, data that indicates an area of interest that was a) generated using historical data for packages delivered to a property and b) in a field of view of a camera at the property that captured one or more first images that did not depict a location at which a first package was delivered at the property; detecting, using one or more second images captured by the camera at the property, movement in the area of interest i) at the property, ii) that is included in the field of view of the camera and iii) was generated using the historical data for packages delivered to the property; determining, using the detected movement in the area of interest and the one or more second images captured by the camera, whether a package was likely delivered; and in response to determining that the package was not likely delivered, determining to skip performing one or more automated actions for the package.

36. The computer storage media of claim 35, the operations comprising: determining that a first package was delivered to a location not depicted in the one or more first images captured by the camera at the property; and in response to determining that the first package was likely delivered to the location not depicted in the one or more first images captured by the camera at the property, generating the area of interest in the field of view of the camera.

37. The computer storage media of claim 36, wherein the location not depicted in the one or more first images captured by the camera comprises a location outside the field of view of the camera or an occluded location behind one or more objects depicted in at least the one or more first images captured by the camera.

38. The computer storage media of claim 35, wherein the one or more automated actions for the package comprises presentation of a warning when the package was likely delivered and second movement in the area of interest was detected.

39. The computer storage media of claim 35, wherein: determining, using the detected movement in the area of interest, that the package was not likely delivered comprises determining, using one or more first images from which the movement in the area of interest was detected and one or more second images a) captured by the camera after the one or more first images b) that do not depict the package, that the package was not likely delivered.

40. The computer storage media of claim 35, wherein detecting the movement in the area of interest comprises detecting, using the one or more second images captured by the camera, the movement of a person or a robot in the area of interest.
